MATH 1503 01: College Algebra Syllabus

Fall 2026

Oklahoma City University, Petree College of Arts & Sciences, Computer Science

1. Instructor Information & Course Material

Professor:	Dr. Tashfeen, Ahmad (MSB 219B, `tashfeen@okcu.edu`[1]).
Office Hours:	Mondays, Wednesdays during 10–11 am and 5–6:30 pm or by appointment.[2]
Textbook	`https://www.khanacademy.org/join/ZZRRWP78`.[3]
Time & Location	Monday, Wednesday, Friday at 9:00–9:50 am in MSB 222.

2. Tentative Schedule

Week	Friday	Topic	Event	(%)
1	Aug 28	Exponents and radicals	Homework 1	5
2	Sep 4	Polynomial arithmetic	Homework 2	5
3	Sep 11	Quadratics: Multiplying and factoring	Homework 3	5
4	Sep 18	Rational expressions	Homework 4	5
5	Sep 25	Linear equations and inequalities	Homework 5	5
6	Oct 2	Quadratic functions and equations	Homework 6	5
7	Oct 9	Complex numbers	Homework 7	5
8	Oct 16	Everything Covered	Midterm	15
9	Oct 23	Advanced equations	Homework 8, Fall Break	5
10	Oct 30	Relating algebra and geometry	Homework 9	5
11	Nov 6	Graphs and forms of linear equations	Homework 10	5
12	Nov 13	Functions	Homework 11	5
13	Nov 20	Transformations of functions	Homework 12	5
14	Nov 27	Advanced function types	Homework 13, Thanksgiving	5
15	Dec 4	Logarithms	Homework 14	5
16	Dec 11		Reading Week	
17	Dec 18	Everything Covered	Final	15

TABLE 1 — This may change depending upon class progress.

3. Grading Criteria

When accepted, work that is $n < 3$ days late will receive no more than $100(1 - 0.1n)\%$ of credit (10% deduction per day). For certain work, late submissions will not be accepted. Any submission that is not easy to read will receive a zero.

Total t %	Grade	Total t %	Grade	Total t %	Grade
		$t \geq 93$	A	$93 > t \geq 90$	A^-
$90 > t \geq 85$	B^+	$85 > t \geq 82$	B	$82 > t \geq 80$	B^-
$80 > t \geq 75$	C^+	$75 > t \geq 72$	C	$72 > t \geq 70$	C^-
$70 > t \geq 65$	D^+	$65 > t \geq 62$	D	$62 > t \geq 60$	D^-
$60 > t$	F				

TABLE 2 — A grade of Incomplete ("I") will only be assigned in case of documented extenuating circumstances. The "I" will be removed in accordance with university policy stated in the online undergraduate catalogue. Please also see subsection 4.4.

[1] Prefix `[MATH1503]` followed by a space to all emails sent to the instructor.

[2] Zoom for a virtual meeting.

[3] Use your school's email address and name as it appears at the online classroom.

4. Policies & Resources

4.1. General Academic Guidelines. For an up-to-date version of the guidelines please visit the university sharepoint, see the OCU course schedule website for the finals week schedule and visit the online classroom.

4.2. Course Description. A college level algebra course covering linear equations and inequalities, functions and graphs, quadratics, complex numbers, exponents and radicals, polynomial and rational expressions, exponential models, and logarithms. Includes instructional videos, adaptive practice, and mastery-based progress tracking. Suitable for placement-exam preparation or as a bridge to precalculus.

4.3. Course Learning Outcomes.

- Demonstrate proficiency in solving linear equations, inequalities, and systems of equations, and interpret their solutions graphically.
- Apply algebraic techniques to analyze and transform quadratic functions, complex numbers, and polynomial and rational expressions.
- Construct and evaluate exponential and logarithmic models, and articulate the relationships between these functions across diverse contexts.
- Utilize adaptive practice tools and mastery-based assessment to achieve and demonstrate sustained competence in core algebraic concepts.

4.4. Academic Integrity. The cheating rule for this class is simple: *don't turn in anything you did not understand*. I encourage you to get help and exhaust your resources. Though, if you turn in something (or answer a question with something you do not understand; can not explain) and I unsuccessfully ask you to explain your work, that will result in an *automatic F in the course* and disciplinary action will be taken. If you've been asked to demonstrate your work to the professor then you'll need to do so in his office hours or make an appointment. If you've been asked to demonstrate your work and you fail to do so, you will receive a zero in the assignment. For more, read the *Academic Honesty* section of the courses' catalogue.

4.4.1. *Artificial Intelligence (AI).* Help obtained by an AI, e. g., Large Language Model chat agent should be documented and turned in with the work. You may use AI to understand a general concept but it should *never* write or solve anything for you. A student who abuses AI will forfeit the right to use it for the remainder of the class.

4.5. Religious Accommodation. Oklahoma City University seeks to be supportive of religious observance among the members of our diverse campus community and to be as accommodating as possible. Students should discuss with their instructor at the beginning of the semester forms of religious observance (dress, fasting, specific prayer times) that may affect their full participation in the course. Students should also compare the class schedule to their own religious calendar to determine if there will be any class days in which the student expects to be absent due to the observance of a religious holiday. *Students must notify the instructor, in writing, of the expected absence within the first two weeks of the semester.* The instructor will then work with the student to develop a plan to reschedule any exams, assignments, or course activities for that day. The instructor, at his/her own discretion, will make reasonable accommodations wherever possible. Students should recognize that there may be some course aspects that cannot be rescheduled or accommodated, and it will therefore rest upon the student to determine whether they wish to remain enrolled in the course or have their grade potentially affected.

4.6. Mission Statement. The Petree College of Arts and Sciences provides a supportive, student-centered learning environment. Through an interdisciplinary curriculum that promotes active learning and individualized instruction, students are encouraged to think broadly, to find their passion, to collaborate with others, and to connect with the broader community.

4.7. Grook.

Put up in a place
where it's easy to see
the cryptic admonishment
T. T. T.

When you feel how depressingly
slowly you climb,
it's well to remember that
Things Take Time

——*Piet Hein (1970)*